RUQING XU

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SUMMARY

Ph.D. economist trained in causal inference, game theory, and economics of AI. Reframes business problems as scientific problems and answers them with theory and theory-informed measurement. Designs incentives that align teams and customer behavior with organizational goals. Scopes ambiguous problems directly with business and product partners and carries them from ideation to adoption. Writes technical documents that make complex ideas accessible to executives.

Skills: Game theory, mechanism design, causal inference, survey calibration; Python, R, SQL, Stata.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Amazon, Seattle, WA December 2025 – Present
Economist, Selling Partner Support

- Designed and launched worldwide the first scalable mechanism to elicit sellers' preferences over support issues, using nonresponse calibration and preference aggregation; results now inform organizational goals that direct defect elimination investment toward the issues that cause sellers the greatest pain.
- Apply economic theory, including principal-agent models and marginal-cost analysis, to ensure aligned incentives in cross-org goal setting and planning.

Amazon, Seattle, WA May 2025 – August 2025
Economist Intern, Selling Partner Support

- Estimated downstream impacts of sellers' revenue-enhancing actions via DiD and matching; informed leadership's mental model.

Microsoft Research New England, Boston, MA May 2024 – August 2024
Research Intern, EconCS Group

- Modeled learning from LLM summaries versus raw data and quantified the rate at which more observations can compensate for lost context in summarization; built supporting simulations.

Cornell University, Ithaca, NY May 2022 – August 2023
Research Assistant for Prof. Evan Riehl

- Applied staggered DiD to 2M+ individual-level administrative records and show that high-stakes testing widened socioeconomic inequality in scores but made scores more predictive of college outcomes.

EDUCATION

Cornell University, Ph.D. in Economics, Ph.D. minor in Computer Science 2021 – 2025
Yale University, Visiting Student 2019 – 2020
The University of Hong Kong, B.A. in Comparative Literature and Economics 2017 – 2021
First Class Honours, Dean's List

ACADEMIC RESEARCH AND SERVICE

Learning from a Mixture of Information Sources. Nicole Immorlica, Brendan Lucier, Yaroslav Mukhin, Clayton Thomas, and Ruqing Xu. 2026. *Conference on Web and Internet Economics (WINE'26), extended abstract.*

Persuasion, Delegation, and Private Information in Algorithm-Assisted Decisions. Ruqing Xu. 2024. *Presented at the 2024 Econometric Society Interdisciplinary Frontiers Conference.*

Stakes and Signals: An Empirical Investigation of Muddled Information in Standardized Testing. Germán Reyes, Evan Riehl, and Ruqing Xu. 2024. *National Bureau of Economic Research Working Paper.*

Service: Referee for *AER: Insights*, *ACM EC*, *JEBO*, and *AMLC*. Organizer, *EC'25 Workshop on Human-Algorithm Collaboration.*